

SMARTPHONES

DOES YOUR CART HAVE A SPANKING NEW SMARTPHONE IN IT? READ THIS BEFORE CHECKING OUT.

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Gorgeous, gleaming bezel-free displays, an array of rear camera sensors, pop-up or slide-out cameras and foldable screens. These are some of the major trends that have infiltrated the smartphone industry in 2019 in full swing, even though some of these saw their inception a couple of years ago. One can argue that there's a smartphone that fits the bill for just about anyone now, while some idealists are still of the opinion that the sheer number of radical innovations, especially on the design front, in the smartphone industry is plunging.



Foldable phones revitalised the dreary 'slab' smartphone design

Nevertheless, choosing a smartphone that best caters to your needs of the present and your needs for the foreseeable future (apart from some lucky folks who switch smartphones every year) is a herculean task. Should you go for the latest and greatest or invest your toiled-for money in an older model that will still serve you well. We attempt to ease your woes when it comes to smartphone shopping this Diwali.

Most smartphone manufacturers produce a plethora of smartphones under different price points. Case in point, Samsung, from their premium flagship S and Note models to their more affordable mid-range Galaxy A

and M models and the budget J models. There's also their ultra-premium mammoth of a smartphone, the Galaxy Fold. Even Apple, for that matter, are following this trend with their flagship lineup alongside the more affordable XR and iPhone 11 today and iPhone SE in the yesteryears. How do you choose between their wide selection of models? If you're going for manufacturers such as ASUS with their ROG phones, the choice is simple, since firstly, they are targeted at one kind of smartphone user – the gamer, and the second and most obvious – they have only one model to offer!

To pick between the price points you must first fully comprehend the terminology. Premium phones are high-end, exorbitantly-priced models that are catered to the power user or a smartphone fanatic, with an array of cutting-edge features, the best processor, cameras, display, and basically everything.

Contrary to popular opinion, flagship phones are not the same as premium ones. They're the company's leading product that has the latest hardware and few, or in some cases, all of the aforementioned features in premium phones. They're also quite pricey, but can sometimes be more reasonable than premium phones. For example, the Samsung Fold is the premium smartphone and the Samsung Galaxy S10 or S10 Plus are the flagships. However, the line can be pretty blurred these days since phones such as the OnePlus 7 and OnePlus 7 Pro, which have considerable differences, are both termed 'flagships'.

Next, we have mid-range smartphones that usually cost anywhere between ₹15,000 to ₹45,000. These are usually far cheaper, but the

sacrifices that illustrate the drop in pricepoint are usually on the hardware front. Cheaper builds, lower-resolution displays, fewer rear cameras and so on. However, smartphones of 2019 such as the OnePlus 7 and OnePlus 7 Pro, Redmi K20 Pro, POCO F1, ASUS Zenfone 6 and more are constantly disrupting the belief that mid-range smartphones come with considerable sacrifices. In fact, possibly barring a few features like wireless charging, reverse charging, cooling technology, and a few others, mid-range smartphones have it all. The latest SoC, great RAM and storage, crisp OLED displays, pop-up selfie cameras, multiple cameras and many, many more.

Lastly, we come to the budget smartphones that usually cost under ₹15,000. They often feature underpowered SoCs, LCD displays, no IP rating, micro-USB charging and a couple of other low-end features. These phones are the best for individuals who are not power users and use their smartphones for basic things such as making calls, sending



The Redmi K20 Pro is the best value for money smartphone in 2019